



Amazon Sales Analysis – Report

Analysis period : 2010 – 2017 | 1,710 orders | 76 countries

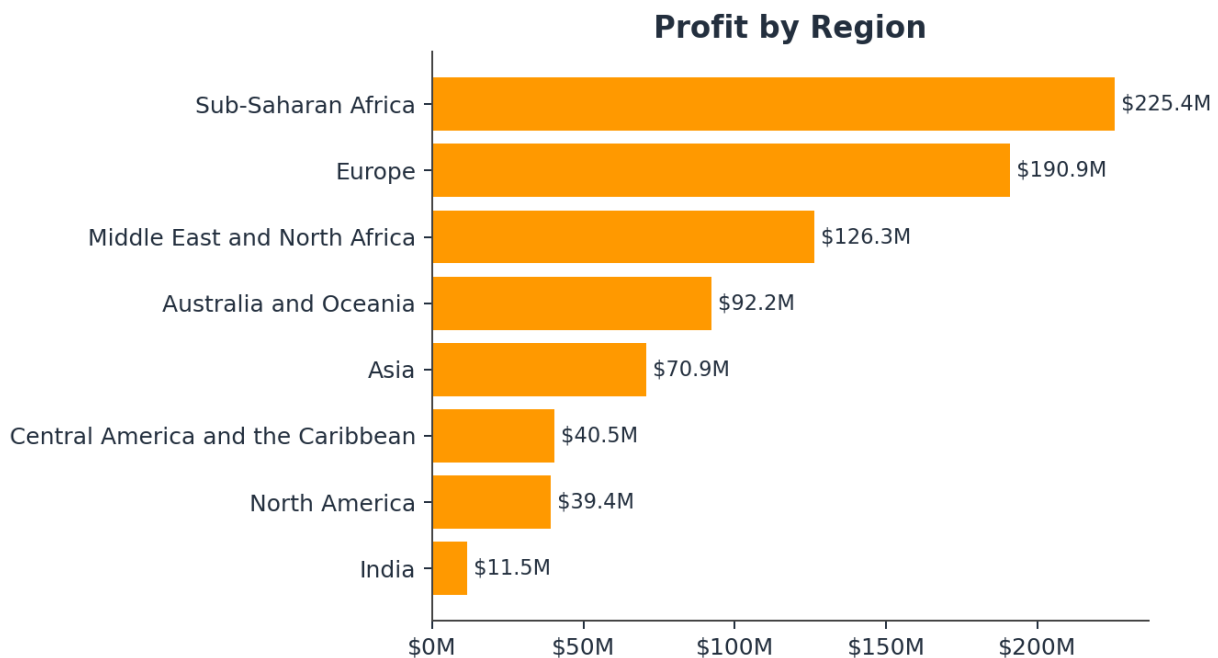
Executive Summary

This report digs into 1,710 Amazon orders placed between 2010 and 2017, spanning 76 countries and 8 regions. It walks through the four KPIs on the dashboard - Profit, Revenue, Shipping Days, and Units Sold, plus the eight business questions the team asked for: where profit comes from by region and country, how revenue splits across channels, how order volume moves by year and priority, and how items stack up on revenue, margin, and units.

\$797.1M Total Profit	\$2.41B Total Revenue	24.3 Avg. Shipping Days	9.09M Total Units Sold
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A few numbers worth keeping in mind before the detail: overall margin sits at 33.1%, offline still outsells online by a wide margin (59% vs. 41% of revenue), Sub-Saharan Africa is the most profitable region on the map, and Cosmetics leads on both revenue and margin, with Clothes close behind on margin.

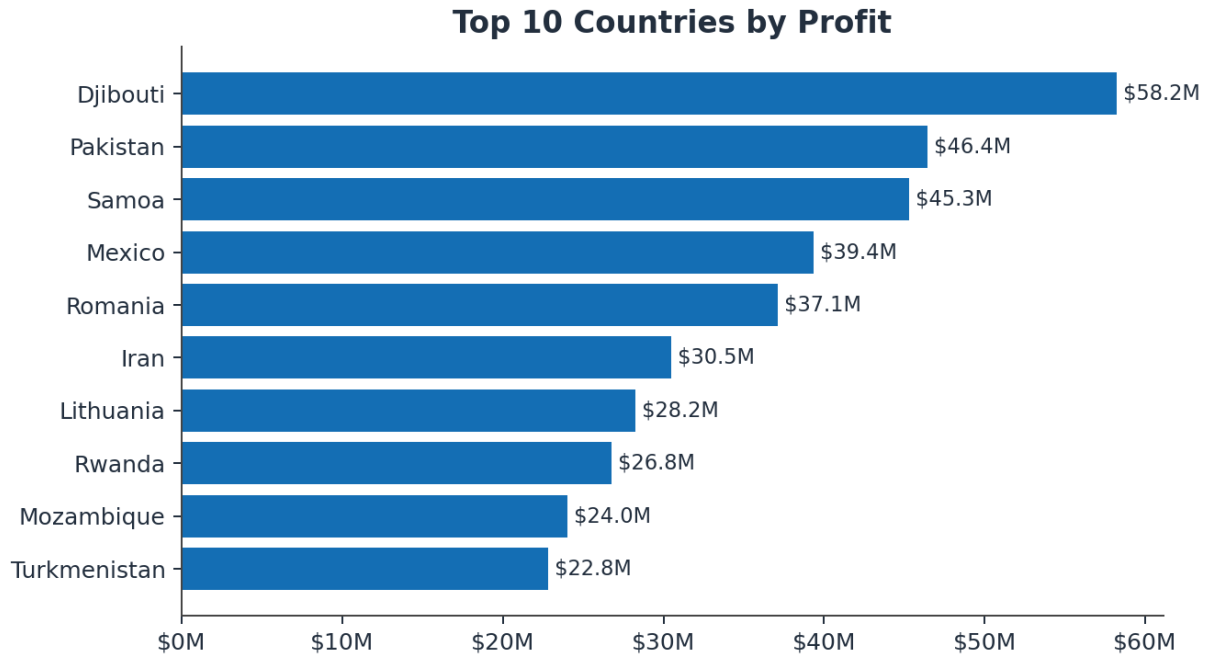
1. Profit by Region



Total profit (\$) by world region, 2010–2017

Sub-Saharan Africa comes out on top with \$225.4M in profit, with Europe (\$190.9M) and the Middle East & North Africa (\$126.3M) not far behind. India sits at the bottom of the list at \$11.5M, but that's really a story about order volume — India is tracked separately from the rest of Asia here - rather than a market that performs poorly. Worth keeping an eye on as a growth opportunity.

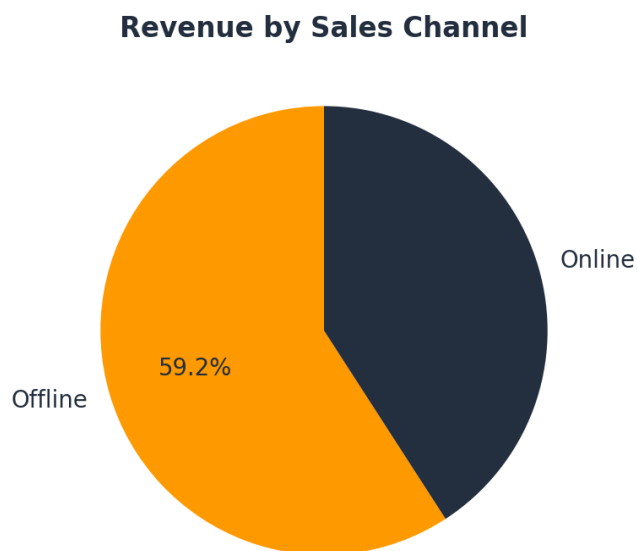
2. Profit by Country



Top 10 countries ranked by total profit (\$)

Djibouti, Pakistan, and Samoa top the country list at \$58.2M, \$46.4M, and \$45.3M respectively though it's worth noting these come from a handful of large, high-margin orders rather than steady volume. No country accounts for more than 7% of total profit, so despite the headline numbers, profit is spread fairly evenly across the 76-country footprint rather than riding on a few big markets.

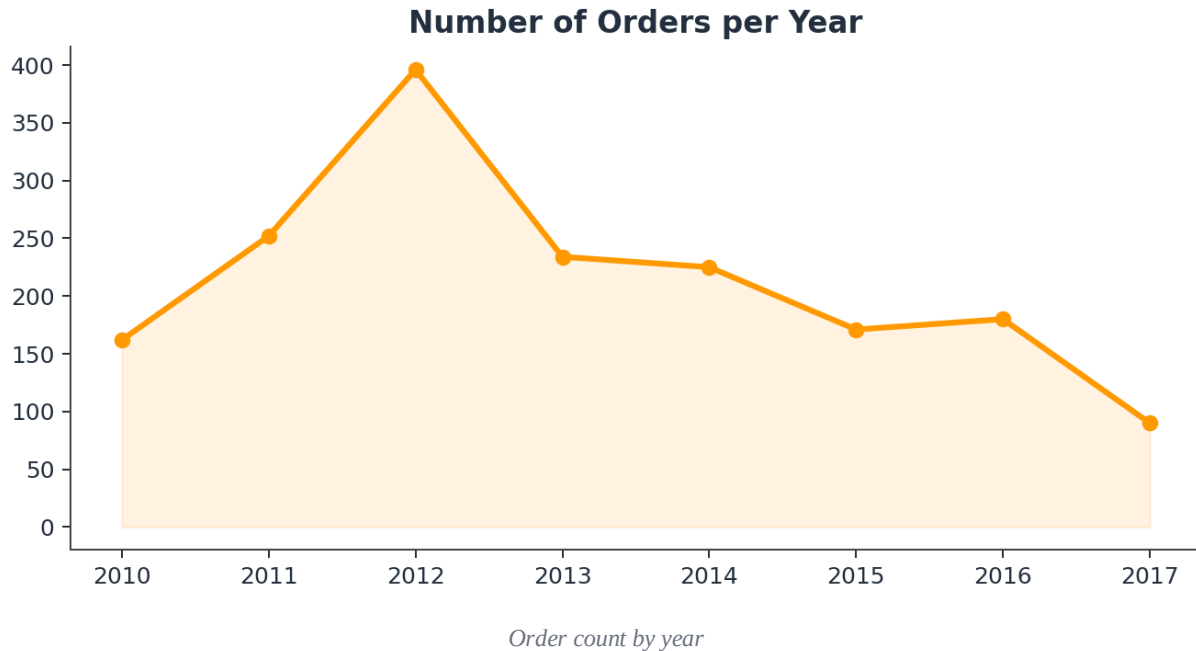
3. Channel Revenue Analysis



Share of total revenue by sales channel

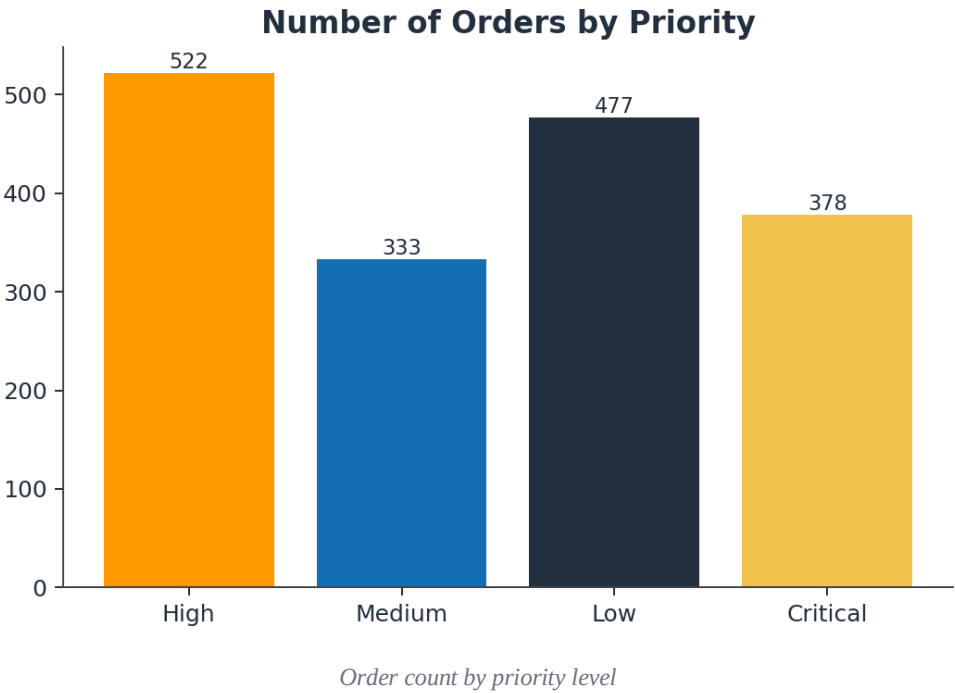
Offline still does the heavy lifting: \$1.43B (59.2%) of revenue versus \$0.98B (40.8%) online. That's not necessarily a bad thing, but it does mean online has real room to grow closing even half the gap would add roughly \$220M in revenue.

4. Number of Orders per Year



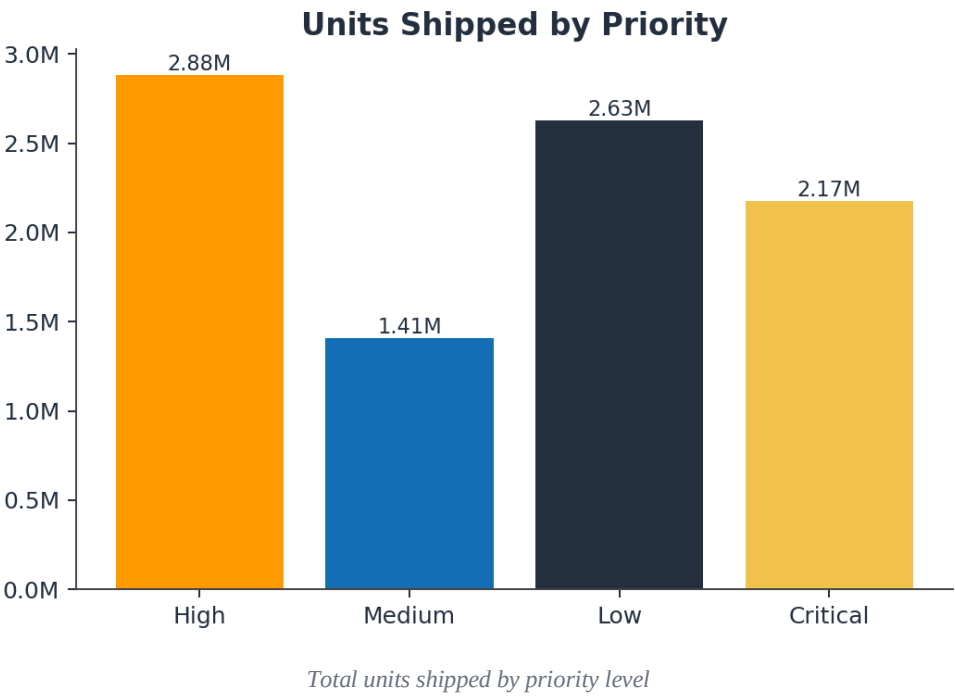
Orders climbed steadily from 162 in 2010 to a peak of 396 in 2012, then fell back through 2015 before levelling off around 170–180 a year in 2016. The drop to 90 in 2017 isn't a real decline - the dataset just doesn't cover the full year.

5. Number of Orders by Priority



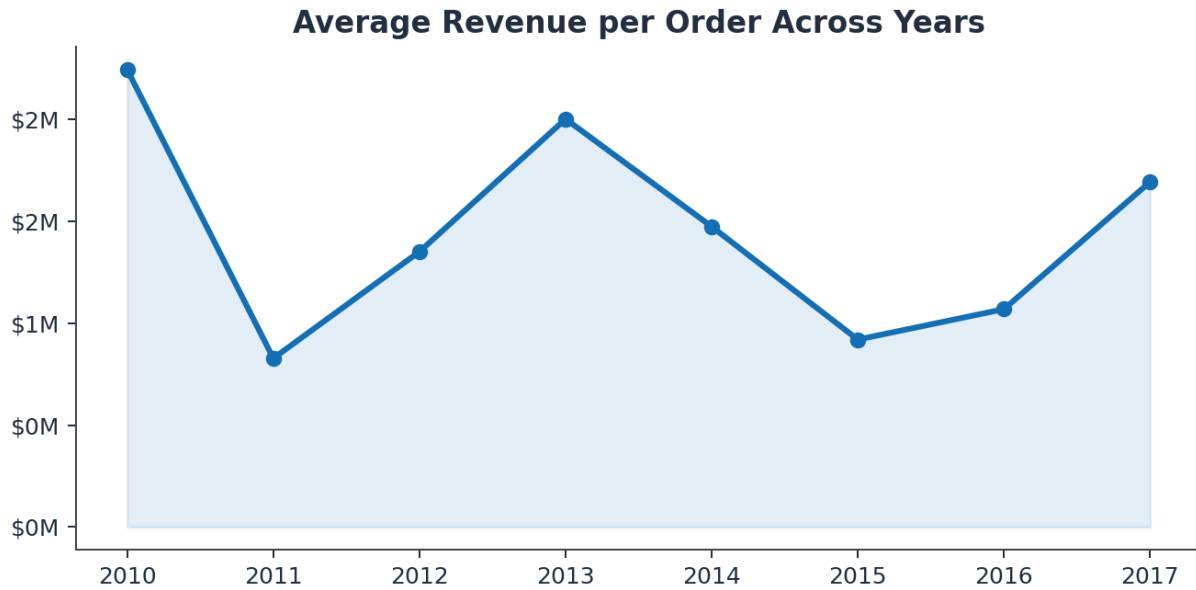
High-priority orders make up the largest share (522, or 30.5%), with Low (477) and Critical (378) close behind and Medium trailing at 333. It's a fairly even split across the four tiers, which suggests priority isn't just a default label slapped on routine orders - it's being used across the board.

6. Shipments by Priority



High-priority orders also move the most units (2.88M), with Low (2.63M) and Critical (2.17M) not far off. Medium falls well behind at 1.41M. Since High-priority orders carry both the most orders and the most volume, that's the tier to watch most closely for fulfilment issues.

7. Average Revenue Across Years



Average revenue per order, by year

Average order value bounces around a lot year to year as low as \$0.83M in 2011, as high as \$2.24M in 2010 without any clear upward or downward trend. With relatively few orders per year, a single big deal can swing the whole yearly average, so this metric is noisier than it looks.

8. Item-Wise Revenue, Profit Margin, Shipments & Units Sold



Revenue, profit margin, units sold and cost by item type

Cosmetics runs away with revenue (\$724.3M, about 30% of the total) and still manages a healthy 39.8% margin on top of that. Clothes is the real standout on efficiency, though a 67.2% margin, the best in the portfolio, even with relatively modest revenue. On the other end, Meat's margin sits at just 13.6%, which is worth a closer look at what's driving the cost.

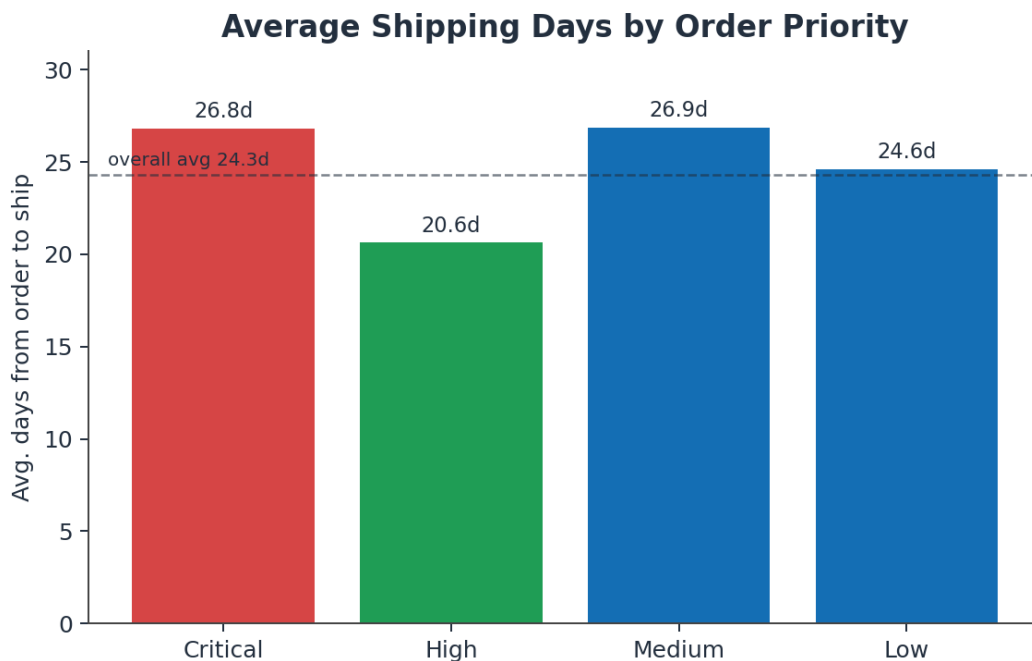
Item Type	Revenue	Profit	Margin %	Units Sold
Cosmetics	\$724.3M	\$288.1M	39.8%	1.66M
Office Supplies	\$530.6M	\$102.9M	19.4%	0.81M
Household	\$469.8M	\$116.5M	24.8%	0.70M
Baby Food	\$180.1M	\$67.6M	37.6%	0.71M
Clothes	\$151.0M	\$101.5M	67.2%	1.38M
Cereal	\$82.5M	\$35.5M	43.1%	0.40M
Personal Care	\$66.3M	\$20.3M	30.7%	0.81M
Beverages	\$63.6M	\$21.0M	33.0%	1.34M
Vegetables	\$49.0M	\$20.1M	41.0%	0.32M
Snacks	\$29.9M	\$10.8M	36.1%	0.20M

Item Type	Revenue	Profit	Margin %	Units Sold
Meat	\$18.1M	\$2.5M	13.6%	0.04M
Fruits	\$5.5M	\$1.4M	25.8%	0.58M

9. Deeper Insights

Slicing the same data by shipping speed and margin turns up a few things the eight dashboard views don't show on their own worth flagging to ops and finance.

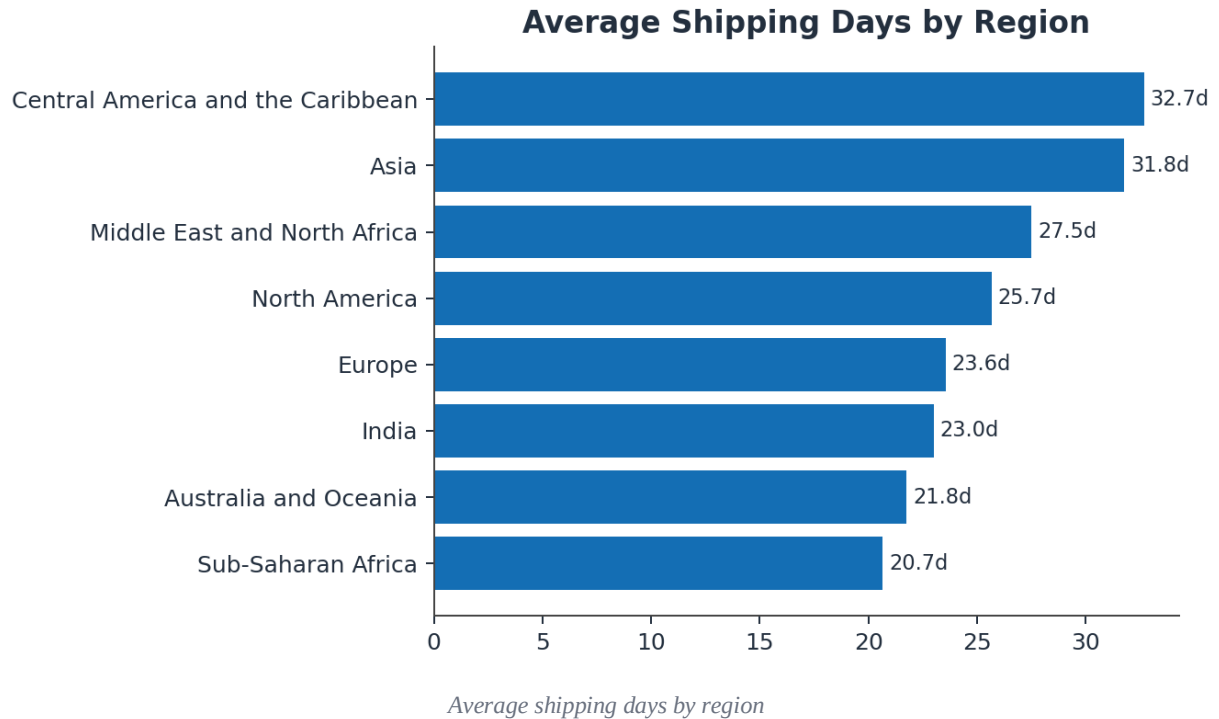
9.1 Priority labels don't predict shipping speed



Average days from order to ship, by priority tier

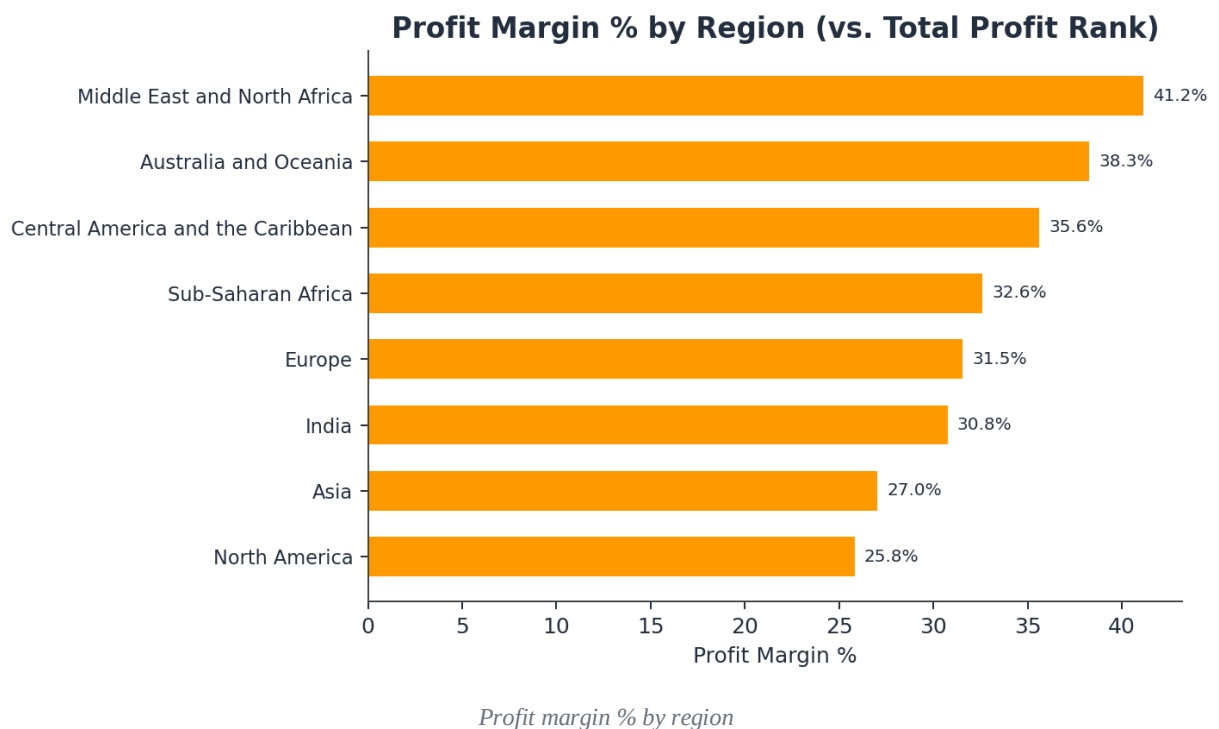
Here's the surprising bit: Critical-priority orders take 26.8 days to ship on average slower than High (20.6 days) and even slower than Low (24.6 days). Medium is the slowest of the bunch at 26.9 days. Only High-priority orders actually beat the 24.3-day overall average. Right now, "priority" looks more like a field that gets filled in than one that actually changes how fast something ships — which is backwards from what it's supposed to do.

9.2 Fulfilment speed varies sharply by region



Central America & the Caribbean and Asia take roughly 50% longer to ship than Sub-Saharan Africa or Australia & Oceania around 32 days versus around 21. That gap stands out even more given Sub-Saharan Africa is the most profitable region overall. If a logistics or carrier review is on the table anywhere, these two regions are the place to start.

9.3 Margin leadership and profit leadership don't line up



Middle East & North Africa has the best margin of any region at 41.2%, with Australia & Oceania close behind at 38.3% — but neither cracks the top two for total profit, simply because order volume there is lower. Sub-Saharan Africa, the profit leader, runs a more middling 32.6% margin. So the regions worth chasing for growth (high margin, low volume) aren't the same ones already generating the most cash, and they probably need different playbooks. One more thing worth noting: online orders edge out offline on margin (33.7% vs. 32.6%) even though offline brings in more revenue overall another point in favor of pushing harder online.

10. Data Gaps & Limitations

Before anyone runs too far with the findings above, a few caveats about the data itself:

- Order ID isn't actually unique. 1,610 of the 1,710 rows share an ID with at least one other row, so what we're calling "order counts" here are really row counts. If anything downstream treats this field as a primary key, it's worth double-checking.
- There's no SKU-level detail, just 12 broad item categories. We can say Cosmetics performs well, but not which specific products within it are doing the work — so these findings point in a direction, not to a specific action.
- No customer ID either, so repeat-purchase rate, lifetime value, new-vs-returning, none of that is answerable from this dataset as it stands.
- No returns or cancellations data. The profit numbers here assume every shipped order stuck, which probably overstates real, realised profit by some margin.
- Shipping cost and carrier aren't broken out from Total Cost, so it's hard to say whether the regional shipping delays in Section 9.2 come down to carriers, warehouse placement, or something else entirely.
- Per-country sample sizes are thin about 22 orders per country over 8 years on average, so the country-level profit figures in Section 2 should be read as directional, not precise.
- And 2017 only has 90 orders versus 160–400 in other years, so don't read too much into that year's dip in Sections 4 and 7. It's a partial-year artifact, not a real trend.

11. Recommendations for Amazon

11.1 Fix the data foundations first

- Give every order a genuinely unique ID (or surface whatever internal key already exists) so order counts and per-order economics can actually be trusted.
- Start capturing SKU, shipping cost, and returns data at the source, that's what turns the category-level insights in Section 8 into real pricing and assortment decisions.
- Add a customer identifier. It's the single biggest blind spot in this dataset and it's blocking retention, LTV, and cohort work entirely.

11.2 Fix priority-driven fulfilment

- Figure out why Critical and Medium orders ship slower than High-priority ones (Section 9.1). This has the feel of a process or routing problem, not a demand problem — and it's probably the quickest win in the whole dataset.
- Put an actual SLA behind each priority tier say, Critical ships within 10 days and alert when an order breaches it. Right now priority is just a label; it should be a promise.
- Take a hard look at fulfilment in Central America & the Caribbean and Asia (Section 9.2) both run more than 10 days slower than the fastest region.

11.3 Grow the right regions and channels for the right reason

- Lean on Sub-Saharan Africa and Europe for near-term revenue (Section 1) - They're already converting volume into profit better than anywhere else.
- Treat Middle East & North Africa and Australia & Oceania as growth bets (Section 9.3) put marketing dollars behind them and let the volume catch up to the margin.
- Push harder on online (Section 3). It already runs a better margin than offline, so growing it isn't just a revenue-mix shift, it should lift profitability too.

11.4 Rebalance the product portfolio

- Keep investing in Cosmetics and Clothes (Section 8) - The two categories where strong revenue and strong margin actually overlap.
- Take a closer look at pricing and costs in Meat (13.6% margin) and Office Supplies (19.4% margin). Both bring in real revenue but the thinnest margins in the whole portfolio either costs are creeping up or these are underpriced.
- Watch the concentration risk, the top 10 of 76 countries already make up 48% of revenue. Spreading acquisition further into the long tail would cushion against any single market's swings.

Key Takeaways

- Sub-Saharan Africa and Europe drive nearly half of total profit, that's where inventory and marketing dollars go furthest right now.
- Offline still outsells online by roughly \$440M in revenue, but online actually runs a better margin — closing that gap is probably the biggest opportunity in this whole report.
- Order priority doesn't currently predict shipping speed. Critical orders ship slower than High on average, and that's the quickest fix available here.
- Clothes and Cosmetics are the two categories where strong revenue and strong margins overlap; Meat and Office Supplies could use a pricing review given how thin their margins are.
- The data itself needs some work before deeper analysis is possible, Order ID isn't unique, and there's no SKU, customer, returns, or shipping-cost detail to dig into yet.